PHASE 1 · PROCESS DESIGN

Delivery-Driver Screening for Grupo Sazón

Prepared by Gianluca Pizzuti for Orbio · 26 October 2026 · Appendix and decision log in the repository, `docs/`

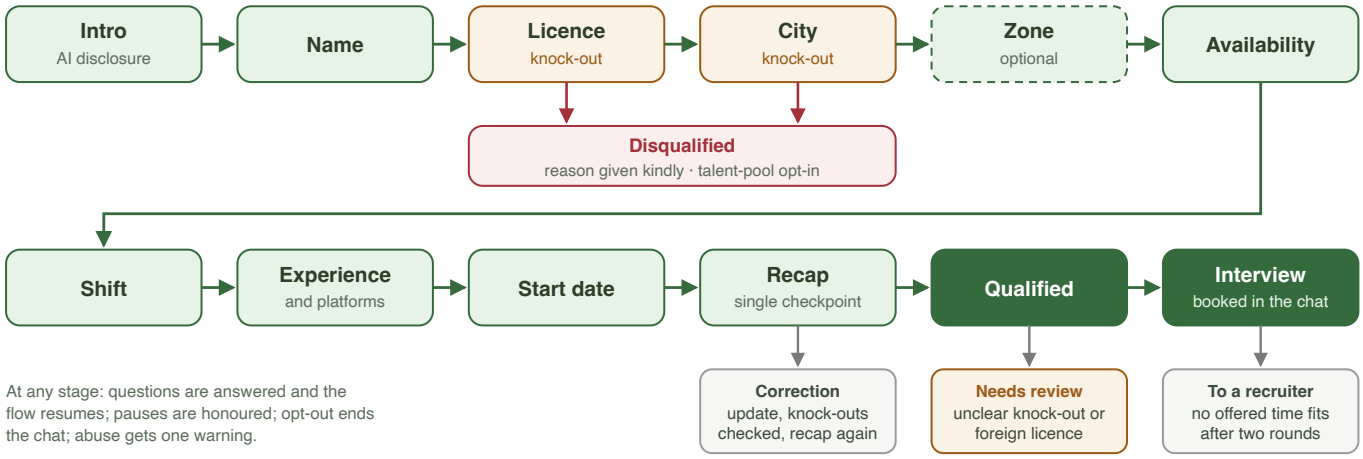
A conversational agent screens every applicant within seconds of applying, so that recruiters spend their time only on qualified candidates.

1 Problems and Mechanisms

Client problem	Root cause	Mechanism
60% of candidates do not answer calls	**Channel and timing:** couriers ignore unknown numbers at work; recruiters cannot retry	Asynchronous chat with automatic reminders
80% of recruiter time is spent on unqualified candidates	**Late filtering:** licence or location issues emerge minutes into a call	Knock-out questions first; recruiters receive only qualified or flagged candidates

Pilot metrics: completion rate, time to screen, recovery rate after reminders, and drop-off by stage.

2 Conversation Stages and Branching



- **Knock-outs first.** An ineligible candidate learns the outcome within one minute; the tone compensates for a more direct opening.
- **Slot filling rather than a form.** "Soy Ana, tengo carnet, vivo en Getafe" answers three questions at once.
- **A single checkpoint.** The recap shows all data once; corrections re-evaluate the knock-outs. A request for a person is flagged and the screening continues.

3 Agent Personality

Sofía, Grupo Sazón's virtual assistant, discloses that she is an AI in her first message. She is warm, direct and efficient, like a considerate shift manager, and never promotional or robotic. She uses *tú*, replies in the candidate's language, and adopts Spanish or Mexican vocabulary once the city is known.

4 Data Fields and Validation

Field	Valid when	Invalid or ambiguous answer	Knock-out
Full name	First name and surname	The surname is requested once	No
Driver's licence	Clear yes or no; car, motorbike or both	Asked again if vague; type asked once; foreign licences follow the hiring country's law	**No, in progress, or type not accepted**
City	A configured service area	Options if ambiguous; asked again if unknown	**Outside the service areas**
Zone	A delivery zone of that city	Unserved neighbourhood: closest zones offered	No
Availability	Full-time, part-time, weekends	Contradictions clarified	No
Shift	Morning, afternoon, evening, flexible	Asked again with the options	No

Field	Valid when	Invalid or ambiguous answer	Knock-out
Experience	Duration in months and platforms	Missing duration requested	No
Start date	Today or later (over 90 days: flagged)	Approximate date requested if vague or past	No

Rules. Every value must quote the candidate's own words, or it is discarded. The model interprets "el lunes que viene"; code computes the date and decides eligibility. After two failed answers, or three requests answered with other information, a field is flagged as *unclear* and the conversation continues.

5 Edge Cases

- **The candidate stops responding.** Reminders after 2, 24 and 72 hours, never between 21:00 and 09:00 in the candidate's time zone, as fixed templates (WhatsApp's 24-hour rule) that repeat the pending question. The conversation is then marked as abandoned, with the drop-off stage recorded; any later reply resumes it.
- **Invalid or ambiguous answers.** Repeated with the reason and options ("¿Centro de qué ciudad?"), never guessed. Manipulation attempts have no effect, as rules decide eligibility.
- **Language switching.** Replies follow the latest message's language, with hysteresis: "ok", "sí", names and numbers do not switch it. Before the city is known, neutral Spanish is used.
- **Candidate questions.** Answered only from the client's approved knowledge base; otherwise the team will confirm, and the question is logged.
- **Technical failures.** Retried, then replaced by a template: the conversation is never interrupted.

6 Outcomes

Outcome	Candidate experience	Recruiter view
Qualified	Books the interview in the chat	Summary, data and the booked time
Qualified with flag	Same as qualified	The reason (e.g. a licence to exchange)
Needs review	Told that the team will make contact	Review queue with the reason
Disqualified	The reason, courteously, and a talent-pool opt-in	The reason; can override
Withdrawn / abandoned	A confirmation / no message	Archived / drop-off stage

Every outcome can be reviewed by a person: recruitment AI is high-risk under the EU AI Act and subject to GDPR Article 22.

7 Message Tone and Length

One to three short sentences, at most 350 characters, ending with a single question after a brief acknowledgement. Plain text with at most one emoji; quick-reply buttons for closed questions; by voice, options are stated in words. The agent never promises a job, invents pay, asks about age, nationality, health or family, or pressures a candidate who leaves.

Correct "Perfecto, Ana. ¿Tienes carnet de conducir en vigor?"

Incorrect "¡Muchas gracias por tu respuesta, Ana! Ahora, para poder continuar con el proceso de selección, necesitaría saber si dispones de…"

8 Open Questions for Grupo Sazón

Each is answered by an assumption stored as configuration: the service areas (the brief gives none: 45 illustrative restaurants in nine cities); e-bikes without a licence (not accepted, as specified); accepted licence types (car and motorbike); foreign licences (the hiring country's law, to be confirmed by legal); "zone" (where the candidate would work); pay and benefits (placeholders); data retention and talent-pool consent (legal review).

> **Interview capacity is the decision with the largest impact.** One interview location per city, on weekday mornings and afternoons, provides about 60 interviews a week per city. In a volume test where about half of 1,000 weekly applicants qualified, Mexico City, Barcelona and Madrid would need about 110, 84 and 83 interviews a week. The options (interviews at every restaurant, group sessions, a first interview by video) are business decisions for the client; the agent already hands unbooked candidates to a recruiter and reports how many.